



RELIGION AND ETHICS

Student's book



Senior One

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FOREWORD

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Dear Learner, The Rwanda Basic Education Board (REB) is honoured to present Religion and Ethics Senior one. This textbook is designed to support effective implementation of the Competence-Based Curriculum (CBC); ensuring learner-centered teaching practices that align with Rwanda's vision of empowering learners to reach their full potential, actively participate in society, and pursue meaningful careers.

As Rwanda advances towards building a knowledge-based economy, education plays a pivotal role. Teachers are central to this transformation, guiding learners to connect classroom knowledge with real-life experiences, thus fostering individual growth and national development. This learner's book serves as a comprehensive resource for teaching Religion and Ethics Senior one. The subject is an integral part of the CBC, aimed at equipping learners with essential knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes necessary for becoming responsible and competent citizens. Through this subject, learners are encouraged to develop problem-solving abilities and contribute positively to their communities.

In pursuit of quality education, the Government of Rwanda emphasizes the importance of using teaching and learning materials that are aligned with the curriculum. I sincerely thank everyone who contributed to the refinement of this textbook.

Special recognition goes to the REB team, who coordinated the entire process. We thank all partners, teachers, and individuals who were involved in the process from the start to the end. Every piece of feedback was highly valued and helped to improve the learning outcomes of our learners.



Dr. Nelson MBARUSHIMANA

Director General, REB



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Joan MURUNGI

Head of Curriculum, Teaching and Learning Resources
Department

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UNIT 1: THE TEN COMMANDMENTS OF GOD

Key Unit Competence: The learner will be able to justify the importance of commandments and laws in daily life.

By the end of this unit, you will be able to:

Knowledge

- List the ten commandments of God
- Explain the importance of God's commandments, laws, rules, and regulations in daily life
- Explain the reasons why God gave the Ten Commandments to Israel

Skills

- Categorize the commandments of God
- Analyse how commandments of God, laws, and regulations guide human behaviour individually and socially

Attitudes and Values:

- Appreciate the importance of God's commandments in daily life
- Demonstrate obedience, honesty, respect and love inspired by God's commandments

1. Introduction

This unit on The Ten Commandments of God teaches the important laws God gave to Israel at the Sinai Event. It explores the categories of the commandments, distinguishing those that guide human relationships with God from those that regulate relationships among people. This unit also examines why

God gave the Commandments to Israel. The unit further discusses the importance of the commandments to believers and society. In addition, this unit also highlights other Mosaic Laws and their significance. The unit clarifies the concepts of laws, rules, and regulations, explaining how they govern behavior and maintain order. Finally, it emphasizes the importance of commandments, rules, laws, and regulations in society.

The keywords are: commandment, covenant, Decalogue, revelation, divine law, worship, holiness, morality, Sabbath, laws.



Introductory activity

Imagine you are in a community with no rules, laws, instructions and regulations. Discuss what might happen in terms of the behaviour of members, solving conflicts, ensuring peace and safety to everyone.

1.1 The Sinai Event



Learning Activity 1.1



Observe the picture and answer the questions

1. What do you see in the picture?
2. Relate the picture to the following story

The Sinai Event refers to the time when God revealed Himself to the Israelites at Mount Sinai and gave them the Ten Commandments through Moses. After leaving Egypt, the Israelites camped near Mount Sinai. God called Moses to the mountain and made a covenant with the people, promising to be their God if they obeyed His laws.

The Sinai Event is important because it marks the moment when the Israelites received God's laws to guide their relationship with Him and with one another. It helped shape them into a disciplined, united, and faithful community.

Here are **the Ten Commandments of God** as given to Moses on Mount Sinai (Exodus 20:1–17):

THE 10 COMMANDMENTS

- | | |
|--|--|
| 1. You shall have no other gods before Me. | 6. You shall not murder. |
| 2. You shall not make idols. | 7. You shall not commit adultery. |
| 3. You shall not take the name of the LORD your God in vain. | 8. You shall not steal. |
| 4. Remember the Sabbath day. | 9. You shall not bear false witness against your neighbor. |
| 5. Honor your father and your mother. | 10. You shall not covet. |

Explicitly, the Ten Commandments are stated as follows:

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. You shall have no other gods before Me. | 5. Honor your father and your mother. |
| 2. You shall not make for yourself any idols, nor bow down to them or worship them. | 6. You shall not kill. |
| 3. You shall not take the name of the Lord your God in vain. | 7. You shall not commit adultery. |
| 4. Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it Holy. | 8. You shall not steal. |
| | 9. You shall not bear false witness against your neighbor. |
| | 10. You shall not covet anything that belongs to your neighbor. |

Muslims also believe in the Ten Commandments of God, but the Qur'an does not present them as a numbered list corresponding exactly to Exodus 20. The following are lines similar to Ten Commandments.

Surah Al-An'am (6:151–153)

These three verses are widely considered the closest equivalent to the Ten Commandments. They contain core moral instructions similar to those given to Moses:

- | | |
|--|--|
| • Do not associate partners with Allah | • Do not approach the property of orphans unjustly |
| • Be kind to parents | • Give full measure and weight |
| • Do not kill your children | • When you speak, be just |
| • Avoid immoral acts | • Fulfill Allah's covenant |
| • Do not kill any person unjustly | • Follow the straight path. |

The **Decalogue**, or Ten Commandments, was given by God to the people of Israel as a clear guide for living in a faithful relationship with Him and with one another. They taught Israel to worship only God, avoid idols, respect God's name, and keep the Sabbath holy. They also provided moral rules for society: honoring parents, respecting life, being faithful in marriage, not stealing, telling the truth, and avoiding envy of others' belongings. In one simple message, the Decalogue reminded Israel that true holiness comes from loving God wholeheartedly and living justly and responsibly with others.



Application Activity

1. In summary, narrate what happened at Mount Sinai as the Israelites were coming from Egypt to the Promised Land.
2. Recite the 10 commandments of God?

1.2 Categories of Commandments



Learning Activity 1.2

Read these commandments and answer the questions

Worship God only and trust Him alone, Do not worship idols or false gods, Respect God's name and do not use it wrongly, Keep the Sabbath day holy by resting and praying, Respect and obey your parents, Do not kill; respect human life, Be faithful and respect marriage, Do not steal what belongs to others, Always tell the truth, Do not be greedy or desire what belongs to others.

1. Among the above commandments, which commandments focus on our relationship with God, and which focus on our relationship with other people?
2. What moral lesson does each commandment teach us?

The Ten Commandments can be grouped into two main categories based on what they teach:

- **Duties toward God:** These commandments guide believers on how to love, honor, and worship God faithfully.
- They emphasize spiritual devotion, loyalty, and respect for God's Holiness.
- **Duties toward fellow human beings:** These commandments promote justice, respect, and peaceful living within the community. They guide us on how to treat our neighbors with dignity.

The following table summarizes the commandments into their respective categories

Duties towards God			
	Commandment	Moral lesson	Explanation
1	You shall have no other gods before Me.	Worship only God	This teaches loyalty and faithfulness to the one true God.
2	You shall not make for yourself any idol, nor bow down to them or worship them.	Reject idolatry	It warns and prohibits us from replacing God with created and earthly things
3	You shall not take the name of the Lord your God in vain.	Respect God's Name	Shows that God's name must be treated with reverence and it is not good to use the name of God falsely
4	Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it holy	Keep the Sabbath Day Holy	Encourages rest, worship, and reflection on God's goodness, love and Power

Duties towards other fellow humans			
	Commandment	Moral lesson	Importance
1	Honor your father and your mother.	Respect for parents and authority	Promotes family harmony and respect for leadership.
2	You shall not kill.	Respect for life	Protects and dignifies human life as sacred
3	You shall not commit adultery.	Respect for Marriage and sexual purity	Upholds faithfulness and sexual and moral discipline.
4	You shall not steal.	Respect for other people's property	Encourages honesty and protection of others' belongings
5	You shall not bear false witness against your neighbor.	Tell the truth	Demands truthfulness and fairness.
6	You shall not covet anything that belongs to your neighbor	Control desires and avoid envy	Teaches contentment and self-control.



Application Activity

Suggest at least two commandments you would follow in your community to show love of God and three to show love of your neighbour.

1.3 Reasons why God gave commandments to Israel



Learning Activity 1.3

Observe the picture and answer the questions



Israelites abandoned God and made a golden calf and worshipped it.

1. What do you see in the picture?
2. Why do you think God gave commandments to the Israelites as they were coming from Egypt to the Promised Land?

During their journey from Egypt, the Israelites faced hunger, thirst, harsh weather, enemy attacks, fear, disobedience, leadership challenges, and internal conflicts. These problems showed their need for God's guidance as a chosen nation.

The following table explains why God gave the Israelites commandments.

	Reasons	Explanation
1	To guide them in their relationship with God:	- God wanted His people to worship Him alone, avoid idolatry, respect His name, and set aside holy time (Sabbath). - Teaches obedience, reverence, and faithfulness.
2	To guide them in their relationship with others	- To ensure peaceful coexistence in the community. - Promote respect for parents, human life, marriage, property, truthfulness, and contentment.
3	To build a just and moral society	The commandments form the foundation for justice, fairness, and social responsibility.
4	To help them live holy and righteous lives:	Following God's commandments leads to a community blessed with peace, unity, and respect
5	To remind them of God's covenant	The commandments were a sign of God's special relationship with Israel. They reminded the Israelites of their obligations as God's chosen people
6	Protect human life	Commands like "Do not kill" ensured the value and dignity of life.
7	Promote honesty and Justice	Commands like "Do not steal" and "Do not bear false witness" built fairness and trust.
8	Prepare them for the Promised Land	They needed order, discipline, and unity as they journeyed toward Canaan
9	Set apart from other Nations	The commandments made Israel different by giving the Israelites higher moral and spiritual standards.
10	Guide Moral Behaviours	The commandments taught the Israelites how to live rightly and avoid sin.

God gave the ten commandments to the Israelites to provide **clear moral and spiritual guidance**, promote peace and order, and help them live as a holy and faithful community.

Obeying these commandments leads to harmony with God and with one another.



Application activity 1.3

Why did God give the Ten Commandments to Israel?

1.4 Importance of the Ten Commandments to believers and society



Learning activity 1.4

Based on your experience as a believer, explain the importance of the Ten Commandments to believers and to other members in the community or society.

The Ten Commandments are important because they guide believers in living a life that pleases God and promotes peace in society. They teach Christians to worship God faithfully, respect His name, and maintain a close relationship with Him. The commandments also help people live responsibly with others by promoting respect for parents, protection of life, faithfulness in families, honesty, and truthfulness.

The following points summarize the importance of commandments to believers:

#	Importance	Explanation
1	Guide believers to worship God correctly	They teach loyalty to the one true God.
2	Strengthen believers' relationship with God	Encourage prayer, faithfulness, and obedience.
3	Promote moral purity	Help believers avoid sin and live righteous lives.
4	Encourage respect for God's name	Teach believers to speak and act with reverence
5	Promote rest and spiritual reflection	The Sabbath commandment helps believers value worship and rest
6	Build strong family relationships	Encourage honor and respect for parents.
7	Help believers control their desires	The commandments teach contentment and self-discipline
8	Promote honesty and truthfulness	Guide believers to be trustworthy.
9	Protect marriage and encourage faithfulness	Strengthen Christian family values
10	Develop a sense of responsibility and integrity	Help believers make choices that please God.

The Ten Commandments discourage harmful behaviors such as killing, stealing, lying, and envy, which destroy relationships and communities. By following the Ten Commandments, believers develop good morals, self-discipline, and a strong sense of responsibility. As a result, society becomes more peaceful, just, and united, because people treat each other with dignity and fairness. Overall, the commandments shape both personal character and social harmony.



Application activity 1.4

Identify and explain at least five importance of the Ten Commandments to a believer and to society.

1.5 Other Mosaic laws for the Israelites



Learning Activity 1.5

Imagine living in a large community where millions of people are traveling together in the desert. They share water, food, shelter, and must live together peacefully.

- In the absence of rules and laws, what problems might arise?"
- And how can they be solved to keep the community together in a peaceful way?

Just as a community needs guidance to stay orderly and peaceful, the Israelites also needed more rules to help them live well after leaving Egypt. God had already given them the Ten Commandments, but these were not enough to guide every aspect of their daily lives. Therefore, God provided additional laws called Mosaic Laws to help them with worship, health, justice, family life, and how to treat others.



God gave to Moses the laws regarding sacrifice offerings

The following table shows the key Mosaic laws that guided the Israelites' lives apart from the Ten Commandments.

	Type of laws	Purpose	Reference in Holy Scriptures	Explanation
	Dietary Laws (Clean and Unclean Foods)	To promote health, hygiene, and spiritual discipline.	Bible: Leviticus 11 Qur'an; Qur'an 2:173; 6:145; 16:115	Israelites were told which animals were clean (permitted) and unclean (forbidden). Examples: Recommended animals to eat animals with split hooves and that chew the cud: cow, sheep and goat. Forbidden animals without split hooves or that do not chew the cud: Pigs.
	Sabbath Observance	To rest the body, focus on worship, and strengthen family life	Bible Exodus 31:13–17 Qur'an Qur'an 4:47; 7:163–166	No work was done on the Sabbath; it was a holy day of rest. The rest was also applied to animals and tools.
	Law of Circumcision	It was a sign of the covenant between God and His people.	Bible Genesis 17:10–14; Leviticus 12:3 Qur'an Qur'an 16:123	Male children were to be circumcised at eight days old.
	Laws of Sacrifices and Offerings	For forgiveness, thanksgiving, worship, and restoring a relationship with God. It taught obedience and gratitude	Bible Leviticus 1–7 Qur'an Qur'an 22:34	Different offerings were given, burnt, grain, sin, and peace offerings.

Festivals and Holy Days	To remember God's saving acts and unite the nation in worship.	Bible Leviticus 23 Qur'an Qur'an 22:34	They observed Passover, Feast of Unleavened Bread, Pentecost, and Tabernacles.
Purity and Cleanliness Laws	To protect health and symbolise spiritual purity.	Bible Leviticus 12–15 Qur'an Qur'an 5:6	Rules about washing, dealing with diseases, blood, and contact with dead bodies.
Laws on Justice and Fair Judgment	To build a just and peaceful society and promote fairness	Bible Leviticus 19:15 Qur'an Qur'an 5:44; 4:135	Judges were to be fair and avoid favoritism (rich or poor).
Law on Caring for the Poor and Strangers	To promote compassion, sharing, and social responsibility	Bible Leviticus 19:9–10; 23:22 Qur'an Qur'an 2:83; 2:177; 2:215	Farmers had to leave part of their harvest for the poor, widows, and foreigners
Laws Concerning Marriage and Sexual Morality	To protect families and promote purity and moral uprightness	Bible Leviticus 18 Qur'an Qur'an 24:2	Adultery, incest, and other sexual sins were forbidden.
Property and Land Laws (Jubilee Year)	To prevent poverty and protect community equality	Leviticus 25	Every 50th year, land returned to original families and debts were cancelled
Law of the First Fruits and Tithing	To thank God, support worship, and help the needy	Deuteronomy 14:22–29	Israelites brought a tenth of their produce and their first harvest to God.

Law Against Idolatry and Pagan Practices	To keep them loyal to the one true God and preserve their identity.	Bible Deuteronomy 12:29–32 Qur'an Qur'an 2:83	They were forbidden from worshipping idols or following pagan rituals.
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Application activity 1.5

Why do you think Mosaic laws were important for Israelites in their daily life as a God's chosen people.

1.6 Rules, laws and Regulations and Their importance



Learning activity 1.6

Imagine your school, home, and community have no rules, no instructions and no commands,

Discuss:

- What would happen in school, home, and community?
- What advice would you give to ensure peace, harmony, and justice?

Every society needs order so people can live together peacefully and happily. Laws, rules, and regulations guide how people should behave and help us know what is right and wrong. They protect our rights, teach good morals, and prevent conflicts. Some rules are made by people, while others are given by God to help believers live good lives. Rules guide daily life, laws govern society, and regulations explain how laws are followed.



Rules and regulations tell us what we should do and what we should not do

Rules, regulations, and laws are essential tools that guide human behavior and maintain order in society. They exist at different levels: in families, schools, communities, and in religious life. Their purpose can be understood in **spiritual, moral, social, and practical terms.**

The following is the importance of rule, law and regulations in the society

	Importance	Explanation	Purpose	Examples
1	To Maintain Order and Discipline	Rules and laws prevent chaos and confusion in society by providing clear instructions on acceptable behavior.	School rules like "Do not shout in class" or traffic laws like "Stop at red lights" maintain order.	Ensures smooth functioning of communities, schools, and families.
2	To Protect Life and Property	Laws and regulations prevent harm to people and their belongings.	National laws prohibit murder, theft, or destruction of property. Religious laws forbid stealing or killing	Ensures safety, security, and protection of rights for all members of society.
3	To Foster Fairness, Justice, and Equality	Rules and laws ensure everyone is treated fairly, without favoritism or discrimination.	Court systems and justice-related laws ensure that rich and poor are treated equally. Religious teachings encourage fair treatment of all, including the poor and vulnerable.	Promotes social cohesion, reduces conflict, and ensures trust in society.
4	To Promote Moral and Ethical Behaviour	Rules guide people to act rightly and avoid sinful or harmful behavior.	Religious laws prohibit lying, adultery, or cheating. School regulations prohibit bullying or cheating during exams.	Develops honesty, integrity, self-control, and virtuous behavior in individuals.
5	To Encourage Compassion and Responsibility	Laws often require helping others and fulfilling social duties.	Builds empathy, social responsibility, and cooperative communities.	Mosaic Laws instructed Israelites to care for widows, orphans, and the poor. In Rwanda, laws encourage community service and helping the needy
6	To Preserve Peace and Prevent Conflicts	Rules and laws regulate interactions and resolve disputes peacefully.	Ensures harmony within families, schools, and society at large.	Laws on property ownership prevent land conflicts. Religious laws on forgiveness and reconciliation reduce enmity

7	To Guide Personal Development and Discipline	Following rules helps individuals develop self-control, responsibility, and good habits.	Shapes moral character and prepares individuals for responsible adulthood.	School rules on attendance, homework, and respect help students develop discipline. Religious fasting teaches self-restraint and patience.
8	To Promote Social Cohesion and Unity	Observing common laws and regulations brings people together with shared values.	Builds a united, orderly, and stable society.	Following traffic rules, respecting community laws, and observing religious obligations creates harmony.
9	To Reward Obedience and Discourage Wrongdoing	Laws often have consequences for compliance or violation	Respecting laws may earn trust and blessings; breaking laws may lead to punishment or social disapproval.	Encourages people to do good and deters harmful behavior



Application activity 1.6

Read the story and answer the questions

Mahoro is the new leader of Ubumwe village. The village has many different people, such as drivers, teachers, doctors, men, women, youth, and children. Mahoro wants everyone to live in peace and freedom. She learns that to be a good leader, freedom must go together with rules and responsibilities. When people respect laws and care for one another, the village becomes safe, united, and happy. Good leadership means guiding people wisely, listening to everyone, and helping the community live together in harmony.

1. Who is the new leader of Ubumwe village?
2. What does Mahoro want for the people of the village?
3. According to the story, why are rules and responsibilities important for good leadership?



1.7. End of unit assessment

A. Knowledge and Understanding

Choose the correct answer:

1. Commandments mainly help people to:
 - a) Become rich
 - b) Know right from wrong
 - c) Sleep longer
 - d) Disobey others
2. The Ten Commandments were given to:
 - a) Punish people
 - b) Confuse the Israelites
 - c) Guide people to live rightly
 - d) Separate people from God
3. Which of the following is a reason why God gave the Ten Commandments?
 - a) To make the Israelites' lives difficult and hard
 - b) To promote justice and peace
 - c) To take away their freedom
 - d) To favor and impose leaders on them

B. Skills

1. Categorize the Ten Commandments into the commandments that regard respect of God and the commandments that regard human relationships.
2. With examples, explain how Commandments, laws, rules, and regulations guide human behaviours.

C. Attitudes and Values:

1. Explain how obeying God's commandments helps people to live in peace with God and with their fellow Humans beings.
2. Give your position on the following statement: "Obeying God's commandments helps learners to develop good character."



UNIT 2:

RELIGIOUS TEACHINGS AND VALUES

Key unit competence: The learner will be able to apply religious teachings and values to promote moral behavior, peaceful coexistence, and responsible living in their daily life.

At the end of this unit you will be able to:

Knowledge and understanding

- Define faith
- Define acts of charity

B. Skills

- Perform acts of charity at home, school and community
- Appreciate the acts of charity done by various people in the community

C. Attitudes and Values:

- Identify the characteristics of faith
- Show the relationship between acts of charity and faith

2. Introduction

This unit teaches important religious teachings and moral values that help people live good and peaceful lives in society. It explains how religious teachings guide relationships between people and God, and among people themselves. The unit shows the sources of religious teachings, such as sacred books and community practices.



It explains honesty and truthfulness, their meaning, examples, and the bad effects of dishonesty, using teachings from the Bible and the Qur'an. Learners study forgiveness and reconciliation and how they help build peace. The unit also explains peace, justice, human dignity, and humility, and why respecting all people is important. Overall, the unit shows how religious values shape responsible behaviour and peaceful coexistence.



Introductory activity

Read the case studies carefully and answer the questions

The teacher uses stones, cones, sticks, chalks or leaves to mark 4 stations. Gwiza is a Senior One student at GS Amahoro School. He attends Sunday School and is a leader of the Heaven Prayer Group at his school. One day, while walking home, Gwiza saw a wallet fall from a passenger's pocket. He picked it up carefully and opened it. Inside, he found 20,000 Frw, a national ID, and a small prayer card.

Although the passenger had already gone, Gwiza remembered the values he had learned at home, at church, and at school. He chose to do the right thing. Gwiza reported the lost wallet to a nearby authority so that it could be returned to its owner with all the items inside. His action showed honesty, responsibility, and faith in practice.

1. What did Gwiza choose to do?
2. Why did he choose to do so?
3. Which values embedded in religious teachings that are implied in the case study?

2.1 Meaning and Examples of Core Religious Teachings



Learning Activity 2.1

Using your experience as a believer, and using various resources, explain and give examples of core religious teachings.

Religious teachings guide believers on how to live good and responsible lives. Although religions may differ in beliefs and practices, they share common teachings that promote good behaviour, peace, respect, and harmony in society. These shared teachings are called core religious teachings.

Examples of core religious teachings

	Core religious teaching	Meaning	Religious reference or statement
1	Love	Love is caring for others, showing kindness, compassion, and concern without discrimination	Bible: "Love your neighbour as yourself." (Matthew 22:39) Qur'an: Allah loves those who do good. (Qur'an 2:195)
2	Honesty and truthfulness	Telling the truth always and not cheating	Bible: "You shall not tell lies." (Exodus 20:16) Qur'an: Be with those who are truthful. (Qur'an 9:119)
3	Human dignity	Human life is important and must be protected.	Bible: "You shall not kill." (Exodus 20:13) Qur'an: Killing one person unjustly is forbidden. (Qur'an 5:32)
4	Justice	Meaning: Treating everyone fairly.	Bible: Do what is right and fair. (Micah 6:8) Qur'an: Be just to all people. (Qur'an 5:8)
5	Peace	Meaning: Living in harmony with others.	Bible: "Blessed are the peacemakers." (Matthew 5:9) Qur'an: Allah calls people to peace. (Qur'an 10:25)
6	Charity	Meaning: Helping the poor and needy.	Bible: Help those in need. (Matthew 5:42) Qur'an: Giving charity is good. (Qur'an 2:271)
7	Forgiveness	Meaning: Letting go of anger and hatred.	Bible: Forgive one another. (Ephesians 4:32) Qur'an: Forgive and show mercy. (Qur'an 24:22)

Core values help people to distinguish between right and wrong, good and bad, and encourage people to live by values such as love, honesty, justice, peace, and integrity, faithfulness, self-denial, respect.



Application activity 2.1

Explain with clear examples and Holy Scriptures references the following religious teaching:

- | | |
|------------|------------------|
| a) Charity | c) Forgiveness |
| b) Love | d) Human dignity |

2.2 Sources of Religious Teaching



Learning Activity 2.2

Read the story and answer the questions

Grace was a young girl who faced a hard test at school. Some friends pushed her to lie and cheat so she could pass an exam. She felt afraid and confused, but she remembered the lessons from home. Her parents had taught her to respect God, to speak truth, and to be patient in trouble. Instead of following the crowd, Grace stayed calm and chose honesty. She studied, prayed, and accepted the results with peace and courage. Though the marks were not the highest, her heart was strong. Teachers trusted her, friends learned from her, and Grace grew in faith and courage. This experience shaped her life full of hope, esteem, and trust.

Questions:

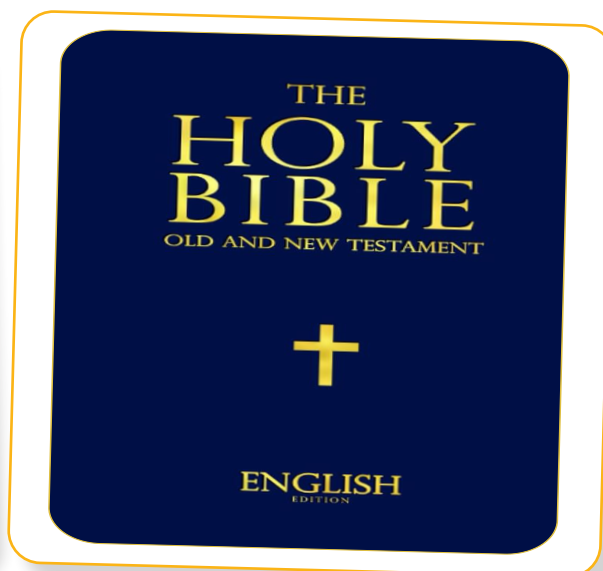
1. Identify the sources of Grace behaviours
2. If you were Grace, would you do what she did? Explain

Religious teachings help people understand God's will, moral values, and proper behaviour in society. The main sources of religious teachings include Holy Scriptures, religious traditions, and religious leadership. Through these sources, believers learn important values such as love, honesty, justice, peace, and respect for others. Understanding the sources of religious teachings helps learners appreciate how religions pass on their beliefs and values from one generation to another and how these teachings continue to guide people's daily lives.

The following are sources of Holy Religious Teachings

- Holy Scriptures

Holy scriptures are **sacred books** believed by followers to contain the word and teachings of God. They are the **primary and most authoritative source** of religious teachings.



Holy Bible and Qur'an are the sources of values for Christians and Muslims

Examples

- **Christianity:** The **Bible**
- **Islam:** The **Qur'an**
- **Judaism:** The Torah

Some of the functions of the Holy Scriptures are to:

- Teach believers about God and moral laws;
- Guide people on what is right and wrong;
- Provide commandments and ethical teachings;
- Promote values such as love, honesty, justice, peace, forgiveness, and respect;
- Help believers make correct moral decisions.

Religious Tradition

Tradition refers to customs, practices, beliefs, and teachings that are passed from one generation to another through stories, rituals, celebrations, and daily practices. The following are some Religious traditions that are practiced in the community.

1. Respecting elders

Respecting elders is a religious and cultural tradition practiced in many communities. Elders are valued because of their wisdom, life experience, and role in guiding younger generations. Respect may be shown through greetings, obedience, listening to advice, caring for them, and involving them in important family decisions.

Examples:

- In many African families, children greet elders respectfully by kneeling, bowing, or using polite language.

- In Christianity, the Bible teaches respect for parents and elders: “Honor your father and your mother” (Exodus 20:12).
- In Islam, children are encouraged to respect and care for parents, especially in old age (Qur’an 17:23).

2. Family prayers

Family prayers are moments when family members gather together to pray, worship, thank God, or seek blessings and guidance. Family prayers strengthen faith, unity, and moral values among family members.

Examples:

- Christian families may gather in the evening to read the Bible and pray together.
- Muslim families may perform daily prayers (*Salat*) together at home.
- Hindu families may conduct prayers (*puja*) before home shrines.

3. Religious festivals and ceremonies

Religious festivals and ceremonies are special events celebrated according to religious beliefs and traditions. They often commemorate important religious events, teachings, or practices and strengthen community relationships.

Examples:

- Christians celebrate Christmas to remember the birth of Jesus Christ and Easter to celebrate His resurrection.
- Muslims celebrate Eid al-Fitr after Ramadan and Eid al-Adha during pilgrimage season.
- Hindus celebrate Diwali, the festival of lights, symbolizing victory of good over evil.
- Traditional communities may hold ceremonies for marriage, naming children, or harvest thanksgiving.

4. Storytelling and moral lessons

Storytelling is a tradition used to pass religious beliefs, values, history, and moral teachings from one generation to another. Stories teach people virtues such as honesty, kindness, courage, and respect.

Examples:

- Christians use Bible stories such as The Good Samaritan, which teaches kindness and helping others.
- Muslims learn moral lessons from stories of prophets like Prophet Muhammad and Prophet Yusuf (Joseph).
- African traditional societies use folktales to teach values, for example stories emphasizing honesty and cooperation.
- Buddhist stories (Jataka tales) teach compassion and wisdom through stories about Buddha’s previous lives.

5. Cultural norms that promote unity and respect

These are accepted values, customs, and behaviors within a community that encourage peaceful living, cooperation, and respect among people. Many religious traditions support such norms because they help maintain harmony.

Examples:

- Greeting visitors warmly and showing hospitality to strangers.
- Helping neighbors during difficulties such as illness or funerals.
- Community work and cooperation activities that bring people together.
- Sharing food during religious celebrations and helping the poor.
- Respecting different people regardless of age, gender, or social status.

These traditions help preserve religious values, strengthen family and community relationships, and promote moral development

Roles/Importance of religious tradition

1. Helps preserve religious beliefs and practices

Religious traditions play an important role in preserving the beliefs, customs, rituals, and practices of a religion from one generation to another. Through traditions, people continue practicing their faith and maintaining their religious identity over time. Religious traditions ensure that teachings, prayers, ceremonies, and values are not forgotten.

Examples:

- Christians continue celebrating Christmas and Easter as part of preserving Christian beliefs and practices.
- Muslims preserve Islamic traditions through fasting during Ramadan and celebrating Eid festivals.
- Jewish communities preserve traditions such as observing the Sabbath and Passover celebrations.

2. Teaches moral values in everyday life

Religious traditions help people develop good morals and values that guide their daily behavior. Through stories, customs, prayers, ceremonies, and family practices, people learn values such as honesty, kindness, respect, responsibility, forgiveness, and compassion.

Examples:

- Storytelling in families teaches children honesty and respect.
- Religious ceremonies encourage values of gratitude and humility.
- Family prayers help children learn love, peace, and responsibility toward others.

3. Strengthens community identity and unity

Religious traditions bring people together and create a sense of belonging within a community. Shared beliefs, festivals, ceremonies, and worship activities help people identify themselves as members of the same religious community and promote cooperation and solidarity.

Examples:

- Christians gathering for Christmas celebrations strengthen unity among believers.
- Muslims praying together during Eid celebrations promote brotherhood and social cohesion.
- Community participation in religious ceremonies creates friendship and cooperation among members.

4. Helps young people learn acceptable behaviour

Religious traditions guide young people in understanding the expected behaviors and values accepted by their families and communities. Through observation, participation, and instruction, young people learn discipline, respect, responsibility, obedience, and good social conduct.

Examples:

- Respecting elders teaches children humility and courtesy.
- Participating in family prayers teaches discipline and spiritual growth.
- Community ceremonies teach cooperation, respect, and social responsibility.

5. Complements teachings from holy scriptures

Religious traditions support and reinforce the teachings found in holy books by helping believers understand and apply them in practical life. Traditions make religious teachings easier to practice and transmit across generations.

Examples:

- The Bible teaches prayer, while Christian family prayer traditions help believers practice it regularly.
- The Qur'an teaches charity (Zakat), while Islamic traditions encourage helping the poor during religious festivals.
- Hindu traditions such as *puja* help believers practice devotion taught in sacred texts.

Conclusion

Religious traditions are important because they preserve faith, teach moral values, unite communities, guide young people's behavior, and support the teachings of holy scriptures in daily life.

Values Learned from Tradition

- Respect
- Obedience
- Cooperation
- Responsibility
- Unity

Religious Leadership

Religious leadership refers to religious leaders who teach, guide, and interpret religious teachings for believers. They are also authority and what they teach is easily followed by believers.

Examples of Religious Leaders

1. High authorities of the Religions
2. Pastors and Priests (Christianity)
3. Imams (Islam).
4. Elders and Religious instructors

The functions of the religious leaders are to:

- Explain and interpret Holy Scriptures

Religious leaders help believers **understand holy books** such as the Bible or the Qur'an. They explain difficult passages and show how the teachings can be applied in daily life. This helps believers follow their faith correctly.

Teach moral values and correct behaviour

Religious leaders teach values such as **honesty, respect, love, obedience**, responsibility, and self-control. These teachings guide people to behave well at home, at school, and in the community, making society more peaceful and orderly.

Guide believers during worship and religious activities

Religious leaders lead prayers, services, and ceremonies such as weddings, funerals, and religious celebrations. They guide believers on how to worship properly and participate meaningfully in religious activities.

Counsel people during challenges

Religious leaders offer advice and emotional support to people facing problems like family conflicts, sickness, loss, or stress. Through counseling, they help people find hope, make good decisions, and overcome difficulties.

Promote peace, unity, and reconciliation

Religious leaders encourage people to **live peacefully**, forgive one another, and resolve conflicts. They promote unity among individuals and communities and support reconciliation, helping society to heal and live together in harmony.

Relationship between the Sources

- Holy scriptures provide the written foundation of religious teachings
- Tradition helps practice and preserve these teachings in daily life
- Religious leadership helps interpret and explain teachings clearly

All three sources work together to guide believers and promote moral values.

Importance of Sources of Religious Teachings in Society

- **Promote good morals and discipline**

Sources of religious teachings guide people to behave well, be honest, and follow rules, which builds discipline in society.

- **Encourage peace and unity**

They teach people to love, forgive, and live together peacefully, helping communities remain united.

- **Help reduce conflicts and crime**

Religious teachings discourage violence, theft, and injustice, leading to fewer conflicts and crimes.

- **Teach respect for others and authority**

They teach respect for parents, leaders, laws, and fellow human beings, which promotes order in society.

- **Support social harmony and development**

When people live by religious values, society becomes stable, cooperative, and able to develop.



Application activity 2.2

1. Which source of teaching corresponds to each of the situations below?
 - a) A pastor explains the meaning of a Bible passage during a sermon.
 - b) A family teaches children to respect elders and pray together at home.
 - c) A learner reads a commandment about honesty from a sacred book.
2. Why is it important for all three sources of religious teaching (Holy Scriptures, tradition, and religious leadership)?

2.3 Love as a core value in religious teachings



Learning Activity 2.3

Observe the picture and answer the questions



- What are the people in the picture doing?
- What do you see that they have in common?

Love is one of the most important core values taught in religious teachings. It is the foundation of good behaviour, peaceful coexistence, and unity in society. All religions emphasize love as a guiding principle for relationships with God, other people, and the community. Through love, believers are encouraged to respect human life, promote peace, forgive others, and help those in need.

Meaning of Love in Religious Teachings

In religious teachings, **love** means:

- **Caring for others sincerely:** Love means **genuinely caring** about the needs and well-being of others, not pretending or acting for selfish reasons.
- **Showing kindness, compassion, and respect:** Love is shown through kind actions, feeling sympathy for those who are suffering, and respecting everyone, regardless of differences.
- **Avoiding hatred, violence, and discrimination:** Religious love teaches people to reject hatred and violence and to treat all people equally, without discrimination.
- **Acting for the good of others:** Love means helping others, making sacrifices when necessary, and choosing actions that benefit others and the whole community.

Love is not only a feeling but also shown through actions, such as helping, forgiving, sharing, charitable acts and protecting others.

Examples of Love in Daily Life

- » **Helping a sick or elderly person:** This shows love by supporting and caring for people who cannot help themselves.
- » **Sharing food or learning materials with others:** Sharing shows love by thinking about others' needs and promoting fairness.
- » **Forgiving someone who has wronged you:** Forgiveness shows love by letting go of anger and restoring peace.
- » **Respecting parents, teachers, and elders:** Respect shows love by listening, obeying, and valuing guidance from elders.
- » **Living peacefully with people of different religions or backgrounds:** This shows love by accepting differences and promoting unity.
- » **Caring for the poor, orphans, and vulnerable people:** Caring shows love by helping those in need and protecting the weak.

Love as a core value is very important because it:

- **Promotes peace and unity in society:** Love helps people live together peacefully and work as one community.
- **Reduces hatred, conflict, and violence:** Love prevents anger and revenge, reducing fights and violence.
- **Encourages forgiveness and reconciliation:** Love helps people forgive one another and rebuild broken relationships.
- **Strengthens families and communities:** Love creates care, support, and cooperation within families and communities.
- **Builds good character and responsible citizenship:** Love encourages respect, honesty, and responsibility, making good citizens.



Application activity 2.3

Explain with clear examples how Love is highly considered value in Holy Scriptures and various Religious Teachings.

2.4 Honesty and Truthfulness as Core Values in Religious Teachings



Learning Activity 2.4

Read the text and answer the questions

Samuel is a Senior One learner. One afternoon, he was invited to clean the Deputy Head teacher's office. While cleaning the classroom, he found a test paper with the correct answers written on it that was to be given the next day. The next day, the same test will be given to the class. He was tempted to hide the paper and show it to his friends so that they could pass it well. However, he hesitated; his heart says, do not cheat or lie, God sees you that is harmful to you. He left the paper on the table after cleaning the office.

3. Which values would Samuel lack if he took the exam paper
4. What consequences would he face if he decided to take the exam paper?

Both the Bible and the Qur'an teach believers to be honest and truthful in their daily lives and condemn lying and dishonesty. When people practice honesty and truthfulness, society becomes more peaceful, fair, and united. Therefore, honesty and truthfulness are core religious values that guide believers to live responsibly and respect others.

Meaning of Honesty and Truthfulness

• Honesty:	• Being truthful in words and actions, avoiding cheating, stealing, or deceiving others
• Truthfulness:	• Always telling the truth and acting sincerely without hiding facts or misleading others.

Examples of Honesty and Truthfulness in Daily Life

- **Returning a lost wallet or item to its owner:** This shows honesty by not taking what does not belong to you.
- **Telling the truth even when it is difficult:** This shows truthfulness by speaking honestly, even when afraid of consequences.
- **Avoiding cheating in school or exams:** This shows honesty by doing your own work fairly.
- **Paying debts fully and on time:** This shows honesty by keeping promises and responsibilities.
- **Reporting facts correctly in work or community matters:** This shows truthfulness by giving accurate information without lies or exaggeration.

Effects of Honesty and Truthfulness

Positive Effects:

- Builds trust and respect among people
- Promotes peace and unity
- Encourages fairness and justice
- Strengthens relationships in families and communities
- Fosters good reputation and credibility

Builds trust and respect among people

When people speak the truth and act honestly, they gain respect from others and create confidence in relationships.

Examples:

- A student who always tells the truth is trusted by teachers and classmates.
- A businessperson who deals honestly with customers earns their trust and loyalty.

Promotes peace and unity

Honesty and truthfulness reduce conflicts, misunderstandings, and suspicion among people. When individuals are open and truthful, relationships become peaceful and cooperation increases, leading to unity in families and communities.

Examples:

- Family members who communicate honestly solve problems peacefully.
- Community leaders who speak truthfully promote harmony and reduce conflicts.

Encourages fairness and justice

Honesty supports fairness because truthful actions help people make just decisions and treat others equally. Truthfulness prevents corruption, cheating, and favoritism, which are obstacles to justice.

Examples:

- A teacher who marks students' work honestly ensures fairness.
- Judges and leaders who act truthfully promote justice in society.

Strengthens relationships in families and communities

Honesty creates strong relationships because people feel secure and confident when they trust one another. Truthfulness encourages openness, cooperation, and mutual understanding among family members and community groups.

Examples:

- Parents and children who communicate honestly build stronger family bonds.
- Community members who work truthfully together strengthen cooperation and solidarity.

Fosters good reputation and credibility

People who are honest and truthful are respected and viewed as reliable, responsible, and trustworthy. Their good character gives them a positive reputation and makes others willing to depend on them.

Examples:

- An honest employee may be promoted because of trustworthiness.
- A truthful leader gains respect and confidence from the community.

Biblical View of Honesty and Truthfulness

Teachings from the Bible:

- "You shall not steal." (Exodus 20:15)
- "You shall not bear false witness against your neighbour." (Exodus 20:16)
- "The Lord detests lying lips, but he delights in those who are trustworthy." (Proverbs 12:22)



LESSONS:

- Believers must speak and act truthfully
- Lying and cheating are condemned
- Honesty and truthfulness are pleasing to God

Qur'anic View of Honesty and Truthfulness

Teachings from the Qur'an:

- "O you who believe! Fear Allah and be with those who are truthful." (Qur'an 9:119)
- "Do not mix truth with falsehood or conceal the truth knowingly." (Qur'an 2:42)
- "Keep your promises and speak the truth." (Qur'an 33:70)



LESSONS:

- Believers are commanded to be honest and truthful in all matters
- Dishonesty and lying are sinful
- Truthfulness strengthens personal and social integrity



Application activity 2.4

1. Why do you think honesty and truthfulness are essential values in Religious Teachings?
2. What are the effects of not being honest in life?

2.5 Forgiveness and reconciliation



Learning Activity 2.5



Observe the picture and answer the questions

1. What are the people in the picture doing?
2. What makes them do that?

Forgiveness and reconciliation are important values taught in all religions. They guide people to let go of anger, resentment, and revenge, and to restore broken relationships. The Holy Scriptures, including the Bible and the Qur'an, provide many examples of forgiveness and reconciliation. Forgiveness is crucial for peace building, as it reduces conflict, promotes healing, and strengthens social cohesion.

Meaning

- **Forgiveness:** Choosing to forgive someone who has hurt you and releasing feelings of anger or the urge for revenge.
- **Reconciliation:** Restoring broken relationships and rebuilding trust between people after conflicts or misunderstandings.

Examples from Holy Scriptures

Bible

- **Joseph forgives his brothers** who sold him into slavery (Genesis 50:20)
- **Jesus forgives those who crucified Him** (Luke 23:34)
- **Parable of the Unforgiving Servant** teaches that forgiving others is necessary (Matthew 18:21–35)
- **The story of the Prodigal son:** The Father forgives his son after repenting and coming back home. **Luke 15:11–32**

Qur'an Examples:

- "Repel evil with that which is better; then the one who was once your enemy may become your dearest friend." (Qur'an 41:34)
- "Whoever pardons and makes reconciliation, his reward is with Allah." (Qur'an 42:40)

Importance of Forgiveness and Reconciliation in Peace Building

- **Reduces conflicts and violence in families and communities:** Forgiveness and reconciliation help solve disagreements peacefully, reduce hatred, and prevent revenge, thereby promoting peaceful coexistence.
- **Promotes healing of emotional wounds and psychological well-being:** Forgiveness helps people overcome pain, anger, and trauma, leading to emotional healing and inner peace.
- **Builds trust, unity, and social cohesion:** Reconciliation restores relationships and strengthens cooperation, trust, and unity among individuals and communities.
- **Encourages moral responsibility and reconciliation:** Forgiveness encourages people to admit mistakes, seek forgiveness, and take responsibility for their actions to restore relationships.
- **Strengthens national and community peace efforts:** For example, Forgiveness and reconciliation have supported peacebuilding, unity, and social reconstruction in Rwanda after the 1994 Genocide against the Tutsi through reconciliation initiatives and community cooperation

Ways of Practicing Forgiveness and Reconciliation in Various Religions

- **Prayer and Reflection:** Asking God for guidance to forgive others
- **Apology and Restitution:** Admitting wrongdoing and making amends
- **Dialogue and Mediation:** Talking openly to resolve misunderstandings
- **Acts of Kindness:** Helping or supporting those who wronged you
- **Community Reconciliation:** Participating in traditional or religious reconciliation ceremonies



Application activity 2.5

Explain the importance of forgiveness and reconciliation in peaceful coexistence and harmony in society.

2.6 Peace and justice



Learning Activity 2.6

Based on everyday life and experience as a believer, and using various resources, research and explain peace and Justice.

Peace and justice are core values in religious teachings. They guide people to live harmoniously, treat others fairly, and respect the rights of every individual.

Religious teachings, including the Bible and the Qur'an, provide many examples of peace and justice. These teachings show how believers should act fairly, resolve conflicts peacefully, and promote equality in society.

Practicing peace and justice helps build strong families, schools, communities, and nations, and reduces conflicts, violence, and discrimination. Learning about peace and justice is essential for promoting harmony and social cohesion in Rwanda and beyond.

Meaning of Peace and Justice

- **Peace:** Absence of conflict, calmness, harmony, and friendly relations among people. It also means living in harmony with others, avoiding conflict, and promoting understanding.
- **Justice:** Fair treatment, respecting laws and rights, and giving everyone what they deserve. It also means treating everyone fairly, respecting their rights, and making fair decisions.

Examples of Peace and Justice in Holy Scriptures

Bible:

- "Blessed are the peacemakers, for they shall be called children of God." (Matthew 5:9).
- "Learn to do well; seek justice, correct oppression." (Isaiah 1:17) – Promotes justice.

Qur'an:

- *"Allah commands justice and good conduct."* (Qur'an 16:90)
- *"Repel evil with that which is better; then the one who was once your enemy may become your dearest friend."* (Qur'an 41:34)

Importance of Peace and Justice

- Reduces conflicts, violence, and hatred in communities
- Promotes social cohesion, unity, and national development
- Builds trust, respect, and harmonious relationships
- Ensures fairness and equality in schools, workplaces, and society
- Supports sustainable development and reconciliation, as in post-genocide Rwanda



Application activity 2.6

School Conflict Resolution

At school, two students, John and Peter, got into an argument over a football match and started fighting. The teacher intervened, listened to both sides, and guided them to apologize and agree on taking turns for the next game.

Discussion Questions:

1. Which values are demonstrated in this scenario or the story?
2. How did the teacher promote peace and justice?
3. What could have happened if the conflict was ignored?

2.7 Respect of human dignity and humility



Learning Activity 2.7

1. Observe the picture and answer the questions



Jesus washing the feet of his disciples is a sign of humility

1. What do you see in this picture?
2. What are the people in this picture doing?
3. Which value is demonstrated in this picture?

Respecting human dignity and practicing humility are core values in religious and moral teachings.

Religious teachings emphasize that respecting human dignity is essential for peace, social justice, and harmonious living. Practicing humility helps individuals build positive relationships, reduce conflicts, and value others, contributing to personal growth and a united society.

Meaning of Human Dignity and Humility

- **Human Dignity:** The inherent **worth and value of every person**, regardless of age, gender, race, social status, or abilities. It involves respecting the **rights, feelings, and well-being** of others.

- **Humility:** Being **modest, respectful, and unassuming**. Humility means recognizing your strengths and weaknesses while valuing others and not being arrogant or self-centered.

Religious Teachings on Human Dignity and Humility

Bible:

- "So God created mankind in his own image, in the image of God he created them; male and female he created them." (Genesis 1:27) – emphasizes that all humans have inherent dignity.
- "Do nothing out of selfish ambition or vain conceit. Rather, in humility value others above yourselves." (Philippians 2:3) – emphasizes humility and respect for others.

Qur'an:

- *"We have certainly honored the children of Adam."* (Qur'an 17:70) – affirms human dignity.
- *Believers are encouraged to be humble, avoid arrogance, and treat others with respect.*

Ways to Practice Respect for Human Dignity and Humility

- Treat everyone with kindness and fairness
- Speak politely and avoid insulting others
- Help the vulnerable, including the poor, sick, and elderly
- Acknowledge the rights and opinions of others
- Avoid boasting, arrogance, or pride
- Promote equality and oppose discrimination



Application activity 2.7

Discuss the importance of religious and moral values for the individual and the society.

Discussion Questions:

1. Which value is being violated in this case?
2. How does this affect the dignity of the children?
3. Suggest ways to respect human dignity in this situation.
4. What religious teaching supports your solution? Explain how respecting human dignity and practicing humility can contribute to peace, social harmony, and development in your school and community.

2.8 Importance of Religious and moral Values



Learning Activity 2.8

Identify at least five points that show the importance of religious and moral values

Religious values are good principles taught by religions to guide people on how to live according to God's will. They come from sacred books (Bible, Qur'an), religious leaders, and traditions.

Moral values are standards of right and wrong behavior accepted by society. They help people to distinguish good from bad actions.

Importance of Religious and Moral Values to the Individual

Religious and moral values are important to an individual in the following ways:

- **Guide personal behaviour:** They help individuals to make good choices and avoid bad behaviour such as lying, stealing, or violence.
- **Develop good character:** Values such as honesty, respect, and obedience help a person to grow into a responsible and trustworthy citizen.
- **Promote self-discipline:** Religious teachings encourage self-control, patience, and responsibility.
- **Give direction and meaning to life:** Religious values help individuals to understand their purpose in life and live with hope.
- **Build inner peace:** Living according to moral values reduces guilt, fear, and conflict within oneself.

Importance of Religious and Moral Values to Society

Religious and moral values are essential for a peaceful and stable society:

- **Promote peace and harmony:** Values such as love, forgiveness, and reconciliation help to resolve conflicts peacefully.
- **Encourage respect for others:** Respect for human dignity promotes equality and unity among people.
- **Promote justice and fairness:** Moral values help people to act fairly and respect the rights of others.
- **Strengthen social unity:** Shared values bring people together and promote cooperation.
- **Support good leadership and governance:** Leaders guided by moral values act responsibly and serve society honestly.

Ways of Practicing Religious and Moral Values

- Following commandments or teachings from holy scriptures
- Being honest, fair, and responsible in daily life
- Showing love, compassion, and forgiveness to others
- Respecting human dignity and promoting equality
- Participating in community and religious activities that promote good values



Application activity 2.8

Discuss the importance of Religious and moral values for the individual and the society.



2.9 End of unit assessment

Knowledge and understanding

A. Multiple Choice Questions (Knowledge & Understanding)

1. Which of the following is a core religious teaching?
 - a) Love of neighbor
 - b) Playing games
 - c) Shopping
 - d) Sleeping late
2. Sources of religious teachings include:
 - a) Holy scriptures, traditions, religious leadership
 - b) Television only
 - c) Friends only
 - d) Social media only
3. Forgiveness and reconciliation are important because they:
 - a) Cause conflict
 - b) Promote peace and restore relationships
 - c) Encourage anger
 - d) Reduce trust

4. Respecting human dignity means:
- a) Ignoring the rights of others
 - b) Treating everyone as equal and valuable
 - c) Taking advantage of others
 - d) Being arrogant
5. Which of the following demonstrates honesty and trustworthiness?
- a) Cheating in an exam
 - b) Returning a lost item to its owner
 - c) Lying to friends
 - d) Hiding the truth

B. True or False

6. Love as a core value in religious teaching requires action, not just words. ____
7. The Qur'an and the Bible both teach forgiveness and reconciliation. ____
8. Practicing humility means boasting about your achievements. ____
9. Peace and justice are only needed in communities, not in families ____
10. Respect for human dignity includes caring for the vulnerable. ____

C. Skills

Yes/No

11. Can forgiveness help reduce conflicts in school? ____
12. Should honesty be practiced even when it is difficult? ____
13. Does respecting human dignity promote social harmony? ____
14. Is humility important for building good relationships? ____
15. Can love and compassion improve community life? ____

D. Short Answer Questions (Skills & Values)

16. Describe one situation in which forgiveness and reconciliation could restore peace.
17. Explain one way to show respect for human dignity at home or school.

E. Attitudes and values

18. Explain the meaning of love in religious teaching and discuss how practicing love can help build a harmonious school community.
19. Discuss the importance of honesty and trustworthiness in your daily life and how it contributes to building responsible citizens.



UNIT 3:

HUMAN RIGHTS AND PEACE IN THE SOCIETY

Key Unit Competence: Learners will be able to apply religious teachings to promote respect for human rights and peace in their daily life and in their community.

Knowledge and understanding

By the end of this unit, the learner will be able to:

- Explain what human rights are;
- Identify and describe the main types of human rights;
- Describe how religious teachings promote respect for human dignity and the well-being of all people;
- Explain the importance of human rights and peace in promoting justice, equality, dignity, and social cohesion.

Skills

- Compare the Biblical and Qur'anic views on human rights;
- Categorize different human rights into civil, political, social, economic, and cultural rights;
- Identify, read, and interpret selected Bible and Qur'anic passages related to human rights;
- Discuss the social and personal benefits of respecting human rights and peace.

Attitudes and Values:

- Protect his or her rights and the rights of others;
- Appreciate that every human being, regardless of religion, sex, or background, is equal and has the same rights;
- Develop a sense of responsibility to protect and promote human rights in daily life;
- Develop attitudes of rejecting all forms of discrimination, abuse, exploitation, or violation of human rights;



3. Introduction

Human rights and peace are fundamental values that help people live together in dignity, harmony, and mutual respect. All humans were created by God with equal dignity and every human being is born with rights that must be respected and protected, regardless of age, gender, religion, or social background. When human rights are respected, societies become more peaceful; when they are violated, conflict, injustice, and suffering often arise.

This unit helps learners understand the meaning and importance of human rights and peace, and how they are closely connected. It explores how respect for human rights promotes peace in families, schools, communities, and nations. Learners will also examine the role of individuals, institutions, and governments in promoting peace, justice, and social harmony.

Through discussions, real-life examples, and case studies from the Rwandan and global context, you will develop knowledge, skills, attitudes, and values that encourage responsible citizenship, peaceful coexistence, and respect for human dignity.



Introductory activity

Read the story and answer the questions

At Umuco Secondary School, when misunderstandings arise among learners, teachers guide them to resolve conflicts peacefully and to support one another. Through these experiences, the class learns the importance of respect, inclusion, and teamwork. As learners choose empathy over mockery, the classroom becomes a safe and friendly place where everyone can learn and grow together.

1. What values do you think are in this school?
2. When there is misunderstanding, what advice does the teacher give to all students?

3.1 Meaning and types of human rights



Learning Activity 3.1



Observe the picture and answer the question

1. How are the people in this picture?
2. What do you think makes them the way they are?

Human rights are the basic freedoms and entitlements that belong to every human being simply because they are human. Human rights are universal, meaning that they apply to all people regardless of age, gender, religion, nationality, or social status. Human rights help people live in dignity, freedom, equality, and peace. When human rights are respected, society becomes peaceful and just; when they are violated, conflict, injustice, and suffering arise.

Key characteristics of human rights:

- They are universal: they apply to everyone
- They are equal: all people have the same rights
- They are inalienable: they cannot be taken away
- They are interrelated: all rights depend on one another.

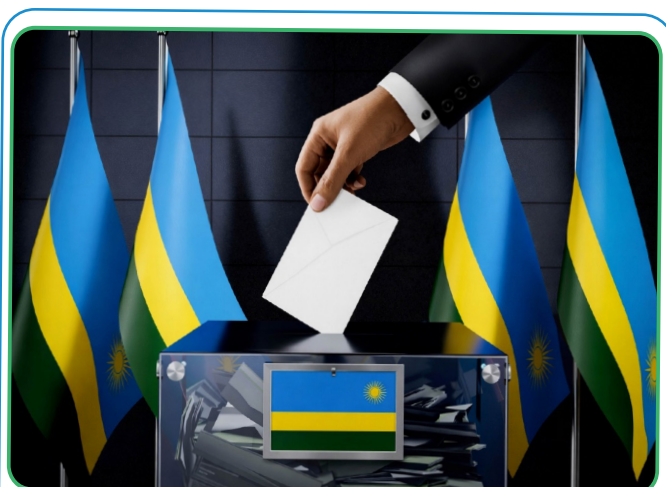
Examples include the right to life, education, freedom, and security.

2. Types of Human Rights

- Human rights are grouped into different categories based on their nature.

a) Civil Rights

- Civil rights protect individual freedom and personal security.
- Examples:
 - Right to life
 - Right to freedom of expression
 - Right to privacy
 - Right to equality before the law
 - Every child is protected from violence and discrimination.



Voting is a political right of every citizen. Citizens are shown voting during elections.

b) Political Rights

Political rights allow people to participate in the governance of their country.

Examples

- Right to vote
- Right to participate in public affairs
- Right to express political opinions

c) Economic Rights

Economic rights help people meet their basic needs and live decently.

Examples:

- Right to work
- Right to fair wages
- Right to own property



Education is a social right

d) Social Rights

Social rights support people's well-being and quality of life.

Examples:

- Right to education
- Right to health care
- Right to housing



People freely practicing their culture through wearing traditional attire

e) Cultural Rights

Cultural rights protect people's traditions, language, and beliefs.

Examples:

- Right to practice one's culture
- Right to use one's language
- Right to practice religion

4. Human Rights and Responsibilities

With rights come responsibilities. Every person must:

- Respect the rights of others
- Follow laws and rules
- Promote peace and unity

Human rights are essential for human dignity, peace, and development. Understanding their meaning, types, and examples helps learners become responsible citizens who promote peace, respect, and justice in society.



Application activity 3.1

1. Using your own words and using concrete examples, define the term human rights.
2. Explain at least 3 types of human rights of your choice

3.2 Human rights in Holy Scriptures



Learning Activity 3.2

Using your knowledge as a believer and based on your experience and available resources, give examples of human rights cases in the Holy Scriptures.

Both Christianity and Islam teach that every human being is created by God and therefore has inherent dignity and value. The Bible and the Qur'an emphasize respect for life, equality, justice, freedom, and care for the weak and vulnerable.

This lesson helps you to understand how human rights are reflected in Holy Scriptures, showing that respecting human rights is also a religious and moral duty.

Human Dignity in Holy Scriptures

Both the Bible and the Qur'an teach that human beings are created by God and are therefore worthy of respect.

- Bible: Human beings are created in the image and likeness of God (Genesis 1:26–27).
- Qur'an: Allah has honored the children of Adam (Qur'an 17:70).

Meaning: Every person has value regardless of gender, race, religion, or social status.

Right to Life

The right to life is one of the most fundamental human rights.

- Bible: "You shall not kill." (Exodus 20:13)
- Qur'an: "Whoever kills a soul... it is as if he has killed all mankind." (Qur'an 5:32)

Teaching: Life is sacred and must be protected.

Right to Equality and Non-Discrimination

Holy Scriptures teach that all people are equal before God.

- Bible: "There is neither Jew nor Greek... for you are all one." (Galatians 3:28)
- Qur'an: "The most honored of you in the sight of Allah is the most righteous." (Qur'an 49:13)

Teaching: Discrimination based on race, gender, or status is against God's will.

Right to Justice and Fair Treatment

Justice is a central theme in both Christianity and Islam.

- Bible: "Seek justice, defend the oppressed." (Isaiah 1:17)
- Qur'an: "Stand firmly for justice, even against yourselves." (Qur'an 4:135)

Teaching: Leaders and citizens must act fairly and honestly. Right to Freedom of Religion and Belief

Holy Scriptures support freedom of conscience and belief.

- Bible: "Choose for yourselves this day whom you will serve." (Joshua 24:15)
- Qur'an: "There is no compulsion in religion." (Qur'an 2:256)

Teaching: Faith should not be forced.

Right to Care, Protection, and Social Welfare

Both scriptures emphasize caring for the poor, weak, and vulnerable.

- Bible: The Good Samaritan cared for the injured stranger (Luke 10:33–35).
- Qur'an: Zakat and charity are obligations to support the needy (Qur'an 2:177).

Teaching: Society must protect children, the poor, widows, and the sick.

Responsibilities Linked to Human Rights

Holy Scriptures teach that enjoying rights comes with responsibilities.

- Respect others' rights
- Promote peace and love
- Obey laws and moral teachings
- Bible: "Love your neighbour as yourself." (Mark 12:31)
- Qur'an: "Help one another in righteousness and piety." (Qur'an 5:2)

Holy Scriptures strongly support human rights by teaching respect for human dignity, life, justice, equality, and compassion. Understanding human rights from a religious perspective helps learners become responsible citizens who promote peace, justice, and harmony in society.



Application activity 3.2

Circle the correct answer

1. Human dignity in the Bible is based on the belief that humans are: a) Stronger than others b) Created in God's image c) Leaders of the world d) Wealthy
2. Which Qur'anic verse supports equality among people? a) Qur'an 5:32 b) Qur'an 49:13 c) Qur'an 2:256 d) Qur'an 17:70

True or False

1. Holy Scriptures teach respect for human life. ____
2. Discrimination is encouraged in religious teachings. ____

3.3 Consequences of violation of Human rights



Learning Activity 3.3

Identify the consequences of the violation of human rights to the individuals and the society.

Human rights are respected when people live in peace, equality, and security. When these rights are violated, individuals suffer physically and emotionally, and societies face conflict, injustice, and underdevelopment. This lesson explains the different forms of human rights violations and their consequences using clear examples. It encourages learners to respect human rights and promote peace and justice in daily life. Human rights violations happen when basic rights and freedoms are denied, abused, or ignored by individuals, groups, institutions, or governments, especially through unfair treatment or discrimination.

Forms of Human Rights Violations

Violation of the Right to Life

This occurs when people are killed unlawfully or their lives are put in danger.

Examples:

- Murder and genocide
- War and armed conflict
- Terrorism and violent attacks



Protection of rights involves rules of law and punishing human right violators

Life is sacred. When people are killed through violence or war, society loses peace and trust, and families suffer deeply.

a) Discrimination and Inequality

Discrimination happens when people are treated unfairly because of their gender, ethnicity, religion, disability, or social background.

Examples:

- Denying girls access to education
- Segregation based on ethnicity or disability

Explanation: Discrimination creates division, hatred, and injustice, preventing people from enjoying equal opportunities.



Child labour is a violation of children's rights

b) Child Rights Violations

Children's rights are violated when they are abused, exploited, or denied basic needs.

Examples:

- Child labor
- Child abuse and neglect
- Denial of education

Children are vulnerable and need protection. When their rights are violated, their future and development are seriously harmed.

c) Human Trafficking and Modern Slavery

Human trafficking involves recruiting or transporting people through force or deception for exploitation.

Examples:

- Forced labor
- Sexual exploitation
- Forced marriages

Victims lose freedom, dignity, and safety. This is a serious violation of human dignity.

d) Denial of Freedom and Justice

This occurs when people are denied their legal rights and freedoms.

Examples:

- Unfair arrest and detention
- Torture and cruel punishment
- Denial of fair trial

Justice protects society. When justice is denied, fear, anger, and revenge increase.

e) Violation of Economic and Social Rights

This happens when people are denied basic services necessary for a decent life.

Examples:

- Denial of education
- Lack of access to health care
- Extreme poverty due to injustice

Explanation: Without education and health care, people cannot develop their talents or contribute positively to society.

Consequences of Violation of Human Rights

a) Consequences for Individuals

- **Physical harm:** Violence and abuse can cause physical injuries, health problems, disabilities, or even death to victims.
- **Psychological effects:** Victims may experience emotional suffering such as fear, stress, trauma, anxiety, and depression, affecting their mental well-being.
- **Loss of dignity:** People who experience violence or discrimination may lose self-esteem, feel rejected, humiliated, or excluded from society.
- **Poverty:** Violence and abuse can limit access to education and jobs, leading to unemployment, low income, and poverty.

Violations damage both the body and the mind, limiting a person's future.

b) Consequences for Society

- **Increase in violence and crime:** Conflicts and negative behaviors can lead to more acts of violence, crime, and insecurity in society.
- **Breakdown of unity and trust:** People may lose trust in one another, leading to division and weakening relationships in families and communities.
- **Growth of hatred and revenge:** Unresolved conflicts can create anger, hatred, and a desire for revenge among individuals and groups.
- **Conflicts and wars:** Disagreements and hostility may escalate into larger conflicts, violence, or wars between communities or nations.
- **Insecurity and displacement of people:** Conflicts can make people feel unsafe and force them to leave their homes and communities.
- **Difficulty in reconciliation and peace-building:** Hatred and mistrust make it harder to restore relationships, promote forgiveness, and build lasting peace.

When many individuals suffer injustice, society becomes unstable and divided, violations fuel anger and conflict, making peace difficult to achieve.

Prevention of Human Rights Violations

Human rights violations can be prevented by:

- Respecting laws and justice
- Promoting equality and inclusion
- Educating people about human rights
- Encouraging dialogue and peaceful conflict resolution

Violation of human rights has serious consequences for individuals, society, peace, and development. Understanding the forms and effects of human rights violations helps learners become responsible citizens who protect human dignity and promote justice and peace in the world.



Application activity 3.3

1. Explain with examples at least four forms of violation of human rights
2. Discuss the consequences of the violation of human rights to the individual and to the society.

3.4 Promoting respect for Human Rights



Learning Activity 3.4

Identify activities that promote respect for human rights at school and at home.

Identify activities that promote respect for human rights at school and at home.

Promotion of human rights refers to all actions taken to make people aware of their rights, to respect them, protect them, and ensure they are enjoyed by everyone. It involves teaching, practicing, and defending human rights in daily life at home, school, community, and the national level.

Explanation: Human rights are not automatically respected; they must be promoted through education, good leadership, laws, and responsible behavior.

a) Human Rights Education

Teaching people about their rights and responsibilities at school, home, and in the community.

Examples:

- Teaching human rights in schools
- Civic and religious education

Knowledge helps people defend their rights and respect the rights of others.

b) Respect for Laws and Justice

Following and respecting laws and ensuring fairness for everyone. This implies uprooting the culture of impiety and punishing wrongdoers and ensuring justice to the victims.

Examples:

- Equal treatment before the law
- Fair trials

Laws protect human rights and maintain peace when applied fairly.

c) Promoting Equality and Non-Discrimination

Treating all people equally regardless of gender, religion, disability, or background.

- Examples:
- Equal access to education
- Inclusion of people with disabilities

Equality prevents hatred, exclusion, and conflict.

d) Good Leadership and Governance

Leaders should act with integrity, justice, and accountability.

Examples:

- Fighting corruption
- Protecting vulnerable groups

Responsible leadership builds trust and protects citizens' rights.

e) Protection of Vulnerable Groups

Special care for children, women, elderly, refugees, and people with disabilities.

Examples:

- Child protection laws
- Support for victims of abuse

Vulnerable people are more likely to suffer rights violations and need protection.

f) Promoting Peaceful Conflict Resolution

Encouraging dialogue, mediation, and forgiveness instead of violence.

Examples:

- School mediation committees
- Community dialogue

Explanation: Peaceful solutions protect life and dignity.

g) Role of Religion and Moral Values

Religious teachings promote love, justice, forgiveness, and respect for human dignity.

Examples:

- Love of neighbour
- Care for the poor and oppressed

Moral values shape good behavior and respect for rights.

Promoting human rights is a shared responsibility of individuals, families, schools, communities, and governments. When human rights are promoted and respected, peace, justice, and development are achieved in society.



Application activity 3.4

Explain at least four activities that promote respect for human rights.

3.5 Relationship between Peace and Human Rights



Learning Activity 3.5

Read the story and answer the questions

In Amahoro village, two groups of villagers are disputing over access to a water source. Some people blocked the path to the water source, claiming they are the first to live in the village, they paid some money to bring the water source, hence, they own the source, while others protested that everyone has the right to water. Tensions rose, and some arguments turned into threats.

1. How does violating human rights affect peace in Amahoro village in the case study?
2. What actions could the community take to resolve the conflict peacefully?

Peace and human rights are closely linked and cannot be separated. Peace is not only the absence of war, but also living in a society where people are treated with dignity, fairness, and respect. Human rights give everyone freedom, equality, justice, and security, which help people live together peacefully.

When human rights are respected, conflicts reduce and harmony grows. When they are violated through discrimination, injustice, or violence, peace is threatened. This lesson helps learners understand how respecting human rights promotes peace in schools and communities.

Meaning of Peace

Peace is a state of calm, harmony, and good relationships among individuals and communities. Peace is not only the absence of war or violence, but also the presence of justice, respect, security, and cooperation in society.

A peaceful school is one where all people respect each other, follow rules, and solve conflicts without fighting.

Relationship between Human Rights and Peace

Human rights and peace are closely linked because one cannot exist without the other. How Respect for Human Rights Promotes Peace.

a) Respect for Human Dignity reduces Conflict

When people are treated with dignity and respect, they feel valued and accepted. Respect reduces anger, hatred, and revenge, which are major causes of conflict.

b) Equality and Non-Discrimination promote Harmony

Human rights teach that all people are equal regardless of gender, religion, ethnicity, or social status. Equality prevents discrimination and marginalization, which often lead to violence and unrest.

c) Justice and Rule of Law support Peace

Human rights promote fairness, justice, and respect for laws. When justice is applied equally, people trust institutions and choose peaceful ways to solve disputes.

d) Protection of Basic Needs prevents Violence

Rights to education, health, and shelter help people live decently. When basic needs are met, people are less likely to engage in crime or violence.

e) Freedom and participation encourage peaceful coexistence

Human rights allow people to express views and participate in decision-making. Dialogue and participation reduce tension and promote understanding.

How violation of Human Rights threatens Peace

a) Discrimination creates division and conflict

Unfair treatment leads to anger and resentment. Discrimination fuels hatred and can lead to violence and instability.

b) Injustice leads to violence and revenge

When people are denied justice, they may take the law into their own hands. This creates cycles of violence and insecurity.

c) Denial of basic rights causes social unrest

Lack of education, health care, and employment increases poverty. Poverty and frustration can lead to crime and conflict.

Human rights and peace are strongly connected. Respecting human rights promotes peace, while violating them leads to conflict and insecurity. Understanding this relationship helps learners become responsible citizens who contribute to peace, unity, and development in Rwanda and the world.



Application activity 3.5

Are human rights related to peace? Justify your answer with concrete examples.

3. 6 Importance of Peace and Human Rights to the Individual and Society



Learning Activity 3.6

Why do you think human rights are important to you and to society?

Importance of Peace and Human Rights for the Individual

a) Protection of Human Dignity

Peace and human rights ensure that every person is respected and valued. When rights such as the right to life, equality, and freedom are respected, individuals feel accepted and respected in society.

b) Personal Security and Safety

Peace protects individuals from violence, abuse, and fear. In a peaceful environment where rights are respected, people can live, study, and work without fear of harm.

c) Access to Basic Needs and Services

Human rights guarantee access to education, health care, shelter, and food. When these rights are protected, individuals can grow physically, mentally, and socially.

d) Freedom and Self-Development

Peace and human rights allow individuals to express ideas, beliefs, and talents freely. Freedom helps individuals discover their abilities and contribute positively to society.

e) Psychological Well-being and Happiness

Peaceful living promotes emotional stability and happiness. When individuals are free from violence and discrimination, they enjoy peace of mind and hope for the future.

Importance of Peace and Human Rights for Society

a) Social Harmony and Unity

Peace and human rights promote understanding, tolerance, and cooperation among people. Respect for rights reduces hatred, discrimination, and division in society.

b) Justice and Rule of Law

Human rights promote fairness and equality before the law. When justice is applied fairly, trust in institutions increases and conflicts are solved peacefully.

c) Economic and Social Development

Peaceful societies with strong human rights grow economically and socially. Stability encourages investment, education, and productivity, leading to development.

d) Political Stability and Good Governance

Respect for human rights supports democracy and responsible leadership. Leaders who respect rights gain citizens' trust and govern peacefully.

e) Conflict Prevention and Peace-building

Peace and human rights help prevent violence and war. Dialogue, justice, and equality reduce causes of conflict and support reconciliation.

f) Protection of Vulnerable Groups

Human rights protect children, women, the elderly, and people with disabilities. Protecting vulnerable groups strengthens society and promotes fairness.

Peace and human rights are essential for both the individual and society. They protect dignity, promote justice, ensure development, and create harmonious relationships. Respecting peace and human rights helps individuals live and enables society to grow in unity, stability, and prosperity.



Application activity 3.6

Discuss at least three importance of human rights to the individual and society.



3.7 End of unit assessment

A. Knowledge and understanding

Choose the correct answer.

1. Human rights are best described as:
 - a) Privileges given by governments
 - b) Rights enjoyed only by adults
 - c) Basic rights and freedoms every human being has
 - d) Rewards for good behavior
2. Which of the following is an example of a civil right?
 - a) Right to education
 - b) Right to food
 - c) Freedom of expression
 - d) Right to healthcare
3. In the Bible, the teaching "Love your neighbour as yourself" promotes:
 - a) Punishment
 - b) Respect for human rights
 - c) Discrimination
 - d) Violence
4. In Islam, human dignity is emphasized in:
 - a) Hadith only
 - b) The Qur'an

- c) Cultural traditions
 - d) National laws
5. Which of the following is a form of violation of human rights?
 - a) Equal access to education
 - b) Peaceful dialogue
 - c) Child labour
 - d) Respect for the law
 6. One major consequence of violating human rights is:
 - a) Development
 - b) Peace and unity
 - c) Conflict and insecurity
 - d) Cooperation
 7. Peace and human rights are related because:
 - a) Peace comes before rights
 - b) Rights destroy peace
 - c) Respecting human rights promotes peace
 - d) They are not connected
 8. Answer Yes or No.
 - a) Human rights belong to all people regardless of age, gender, or nationality.
 - b) Religious teachings encourage respect for human dignity.
 - c) Peace can exist where human rights are constantly violated.
 - d) Respecting human rights is only the duty of the government.
 - e) Human rights help promote unity and social harmony.
 9. Describe how human rights are taught in Holy Scriptures
 10. Identify and explain with examples two forms of human rights violations common in society.
 11. Identify and discuss 4 forms of violation of human rights and their consequences
 12. Why is it important for young people in Rwanda to respect human rights and promote peace?.



UNIT 4:

THE PURPOSE OF CREATION IN CHRISTIAN AND ISLAMIC VIEW

Key Unit Competence: By the end of this unit, learners will be able to explain the purpose of human creation according to Christian and Islamic teachings and apply this knowledge to live responsibly, morally, and in harmony with God, self, others, and with the environment.

Knowledge and understanding

By the end of this unit, the learner will be able to:

- Identify the components of creation: universe, nature, humans, animals, and plants
- Explain the concept of creation in Christianity and Islam perspective
- Describe the Biblical and Islamic view of purpose of human creation
- Describe the benefits of living according to God's purpose

Skills

- Describe aspects of creation in their environment
- Compare Christian and Islamic views on creation in simple terms
- Compare and contrast Christian and Islamic teachings on the purpose of human creation
- Discuss practical ways to live according to God's purpose in school, home, and community.

Attitudes and Values:

- Develop a sense of respect and responsibility toward the environment and living beings
- Develop respect, care, and responsibility toward the environment and living beings
- Value peaceful and harmonious living as part of fulfilling God's purpose for humanity
- Show respect, honesty, and compassion as part of fulfilling human purpose
- Appreciate the value of peace and human rights as essential for human dignity and social harmony.

4. Introduction

Human beings, old or young, men and women, often ask important questions such as: Why am I alive? What is the meaning of life? What is my responsibility in the world? Religion helps people find answers to these questions by guiding them on the purpose of human life.

In both Christianity and Islam, life is believed to be a gift from God and has a clear purpose. These religions teach that human beings are created to know, love, worship, and serve God, and to live in harmony with others by practicing moral values such as love, honesty, justice, peace, humility, and respect for human dignity.

This unit will help learners understand how Christian and Islamic teachings explain the purpose of life, using examples from the Bible and the Qur'an. You will explore how these teachings guide believers to live responsibly, care for others, protect creation, and prepare for life after death.

You will also develop knowledge, critical thinking skills, positive attitudes, and moral values that help you make good choices, respect others, and live meaningful and peaceful lives in society.



Introductory activity 4.1

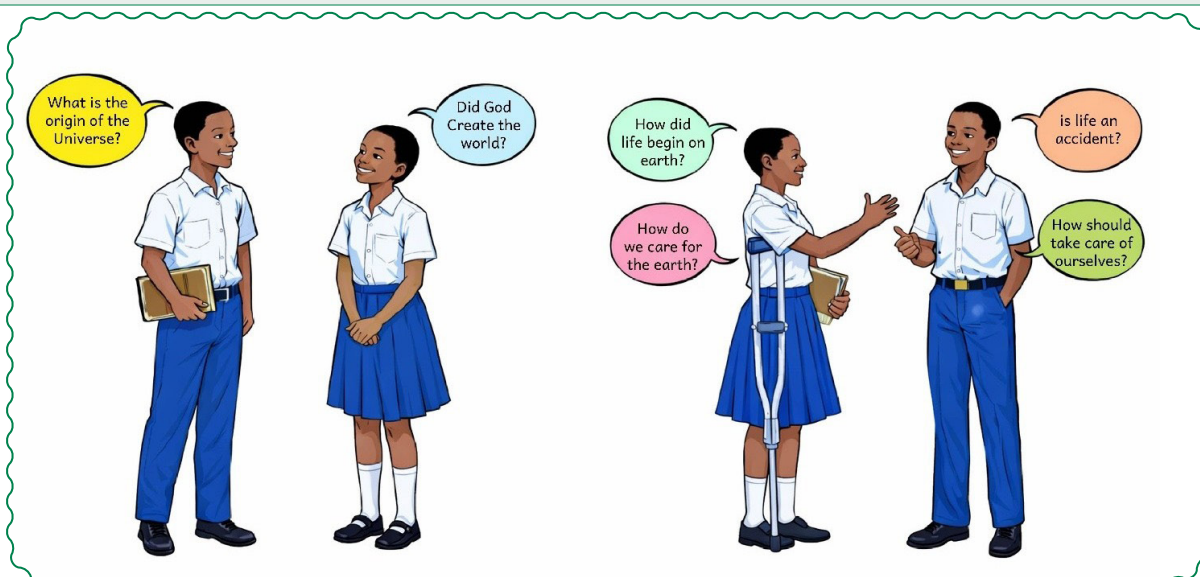
How nature and the world came into existence, and who holds or controls everything in the world?

4.1 Introduction to Creation and origin of the Natural World



Learning Activity 4.1

Think about nature and the world around you. How did they come into existence? Who holds everything we see in the world?



The origin and existence of the natural world is the source of many inquiries

There are theories that explain how everything we see came into existence. The following table shows the details on the position and explanation of each theory:

	Theory	Main idea	Explanation	Key point
1	Religious (Creation) Theory	God created the universe and everything in it	God made the sky, land, water, plants, animals, and human beings in an orderly way (Genesis 1–2).	God as the creator and purpose of creation
2	Big Bang Theory	The universe began from a powerful explosion	The universe started as a small hot mass that exploded and expanded to form stars, planets, and galaxies.	How the universe began scientifically
3	Evolution Theory	Living things developed slowly over time	Plants, animals, and human beings changed gradually over many years to become what they are today.	Development and change of living things
4	African Traditional View	A Supreme Being created and ordered the world	God created nature and human beings; nature is sacred and must be respected.	Harmony between humans and nature
5	Religion and Science Together	Religion and science explain different aspects	Religion explains who and why; science explains how creation developed.	Complementary understanding
6	Atheistic theory	No Supernatural Intervention but nature is self-explanatory	It proclaims that life evolved through natural processes (mutation, natural selection) without any divine involvement, meaning no essential purpose, design, or creator.	Natural processes of existence

All these theories try to explain how the natural world and the universe came into existence. Religious views focus on God as the creator, while scientific theories explain the processes of development.



Application activity 4.1

After exploring some theories on how the natural world and the universe came into existence, explain three theories showing the main idea and key points.

4.2 Creation in the Christian and Islamic view



Learning Activity 4.2

Using various resources, and based on your experience as a believer, research on Christian and Islamic views on creation, highlighting differences and similarities.

Creation is one way of explaining the origin of the natural world. Creation refers to the act by which God brought the world and everything in it into existence. It explains how life, nature, human beings, and the universe began. God created the world with purpose and order. In Religion, creation explains how the natural world, such as the sky, land, water, plants, animals, and human beings came to be. Creation shows God as the source of life, order, and harmony in the universe.

a) Creation in the Christian View

There are two stories of creation in the Bible. These are shared by Christians and Jews. The first creation story is found in Genesis 1-2:3, while the second story is found in Genesis 2:4-25. God created all things in six days and on the seventh day he rested. He made this day a day of rest and was named Sabbath.

According to the Bible, God is the creator of the universe.

- God created the world in six days and rested on the seventh day (Genesis 1-2).
- God created light, sky, land, plants, animals, and human beings.
- Human beings were created in God's image and likeness, showing their special value and dignity (Genesis 1:27).
- God saw that everything He created was good, showing harmony and order in creation.

	Day	What God created	Biblical references
1	Day 1	Day and night or light and darkness	Genesis 1:3-5
2	Day 2	The Sky/atmosphere:	Genesis 1:6-8
3	Day 3	Land, seas and plants	Genesis 1:9-13
4	Day 4	Sun, moon and the stars / Lights in the sky	Genesis 1:14-19
5	Day 5	Aquatic animals (Sea creatures) and birds	Genesis 1:20-23

6	Day 6	Humans, domestic animals, reptiles, wild animals and climbing animals: Land creatures and humans	Genesis 1:24-25
7	Day 7	Rest/ Taking a break	Genesis 2:1-3

God is the source of life, and humans are responsible for caring for creation.

b) Creation in the Islamic View (Qur'an)

In Islam, Allah is the Creator of everything in the heavens and the earth.

- Allah created the universe with wisdom and purpose (Qur'an 21:16).
- Human beings were created from clay, and Allah breathed life into them (Qur'an 15:26-29).
- Creation is a sign of Allah's power, and humans are entrusted as stewards (Khalifah) of the earth.

Allah alone is the Creator, and humans must live responsibly and obey His guidance.

Both Christianity and Islam explain that:

- The earth, sky, sun, moon, plants, animals, and people all have one source God.
- Everything in the world has a purpose and follows a natural order set by God.
- Human beings depend on nature for survival and must respect it.

Values Learned from Creation

- Respect for life
- Responsibility and stewardship
- Humility
- Gratitude
- Care for the environment.

The creation of the world shows that everything we see has an origin, order, and purpose. Both Christianity and Islam teach that God is the Creator, and human beings have a responsibility to care for creation and live according to moral values. Understanding creation helps learners live responsibly, peacefully, and respectfully in society.



Application activity 4.2

Explain briefly the creation in both the Christian and Islamic view.

4.3 The purpose of the creation of humans in Christian and Islamic teaching



Learning Activity 4.3

Read the story and answer the questions

God said, Let us make man in our image in our likeness, let them rule over the fish, the sea and the birds of air, over the livestock, over the earth, and over all creatures that move along the ground. Genesis 1:26.

1. Why did God create humans?
2. Brainstorm on other reasons why God created humans
3. What do you think are the unique characteristics of humans in comparison to other creation?

The purpose of human creation explains why God created human beings and the roles and responsibilities He gave them in the world. Both Christianity and Islam teach that human life is not accidental but has meaning, value, and direction given by God.

The purpose of creation in the Christian view

Humans are special and worthy of respect. Christians believe that Humans are created in the image of God. This means that:

- Humankind is unique and special among all other God's creations
- People should represent God in the way they live and act
- Men and women are made to have a special relationship with God
- Humans are free to make their own decisions
- Men and women are responsible for the stewardship of life in the world.

The following is the summary of purpose of creation of humans according to Christianity:

a) Humans were created to know, love, and worship God and to make Him known to others

Christians believe that God created human beings to have a relationship with Him.

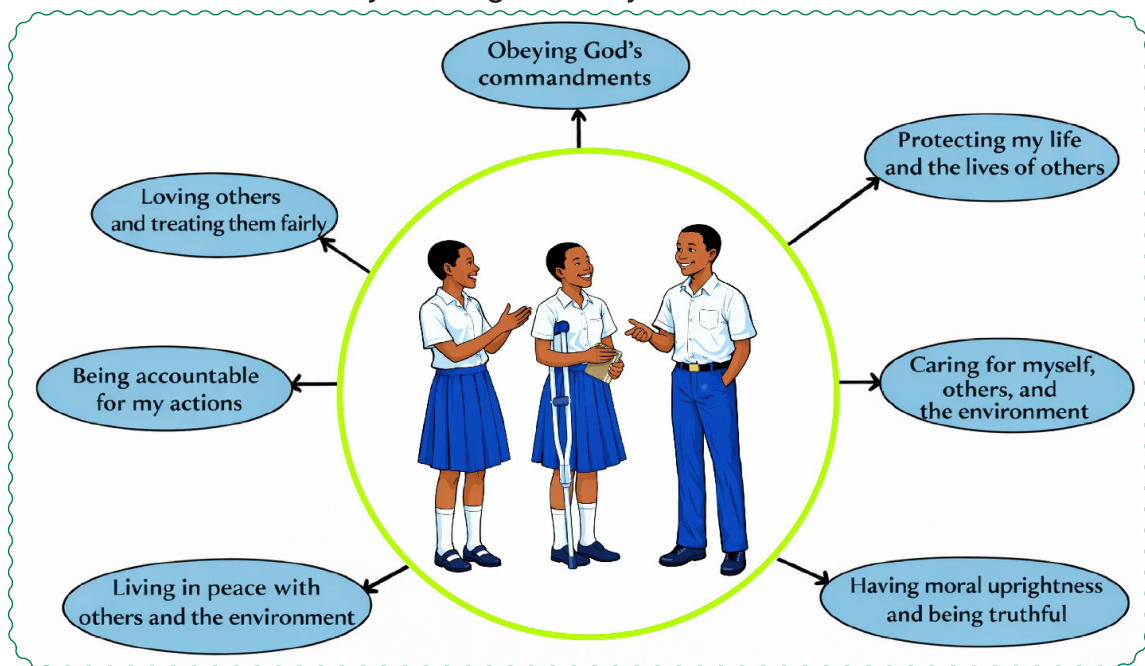
- Human beings are called to know God, love Him, and worship Him.
- Humans are created to praise, honor, and acknowledge God as the Creator, making Him known to others (Revelation 4:11)
- Humans offer worship and live lives of faithful service, enjoying the eternal pleasures God offers (Psalm 100, Ecclesiastes 12:13-14).
- Kingdom Expansion: To participate in God's kingdom work, allowing the world to know Him through believers (Ephesians 1:12).
- "Love the Lord your God with all your heart..." (Matthew 22:37).

b) Humans were created to live according to God's Will

- Humans are expected to obey God's commandments and live holy lives. They should follow the teachings of Jesus Christ, such as love, forgiveness, humility, and justice.
- Humans are image bearers of God: this means that they have spiritual, moral, and rational capacities relating to God and allowing for communion and reflection of His nature (Genesis 1:26-27).
- Bible reference: "Be holy, because I am holy." (1 Peter 1:16).

c) Humans were created to love and serve others

- God created humans to live in community, showing love and care to one another. Humans are called to serve others, especially the poor and needy.
- Relationship & Fellowship: To have a deep, eternal, and joyful relationship with God, as He is a relational being who desires to share His love (John 17:4, 1 Peter 3:9).
- Bible reference: "Love your neighbor as yourself." (Mark 12:31).



Living according to the purpose of creation helps people to be happy

a) Humans were created to take care of creation

- Humans were given the responsibility to care for the earth and all living things.
- Stewardship & Dominion: To rule over and care for the earth and its creatures as God's representatives (Genesis 1:28).
- Bible reference: "Fill the earth and subdue it." (Genesis 1:28)
- This means protecting the environment and using resources responsibly.

b) Humans were created to prepare for eternal life

- Christians believe life on earth prepares human beings for eternal life with God. Therefore, faith, good works, and obedience are important.

- Bible reference: "I am the way, the truth, and the life." (John 14:6).

Purpose of Human Creation in Islamic Teaching

c) Humans were created to worship Allah alone

- The main purpose of human creation in Islam is worship of Allah.
- Worship includes prayer, obedience, and good behavior.
- Qur'anic reference: "I did not create jinn and mankind except to worship Me." (Qur'an 51:56).

d) Humans were created to obey Allah's Commands

- Humans are expected to follow Allah's guidance as revealed in the Qur'an and Sunnah.
- Obedience leads to a righteous life.
- Qur'anic reference: "Obey Allah and obey the Messenger." (Qur'an 4:59)

e) Humans were created to be stewards (Khalifah) on Earth

- Humans are appointed as caretakers of the earth.
- They must protect nature and use resources wisely.
- Qur'anic reference: "I will place a steward (Khalifah) on earth." (Qur'an 2:30)

f) Humans were created to do good and promote justice

- Humans are created to practice good deeds, justice, honesty, and compassion.
- Qur'anic reference: "Indeed, Allah commands justice and doing good." (Qur'an 16:90)
- Humans were created to prepare for the Hereafter
- Life on earth is a test that prepares humans for life after death.
- Good deeds lead to reward in the Hereafter.
- Qur'anic reference: "Whoever does good will see it." (Qur'an 99:7)

Similarities between Christian and Islamic Teachings

Both religions teach that:

- Humans are created by **God**
- Life has **purpose and meaning**
- Humans must **worship God**
- Humans should **love and serve others**
- Humans are responsible **for caring for creation**
- Life on earth prepares **humans for life after death.**



Application activity 4.3

Discuss the Christian and Islamic views of the purpose of the creation of humans.

4.4 Importance of living according to the purpose of creation



Learning Activity 4.4

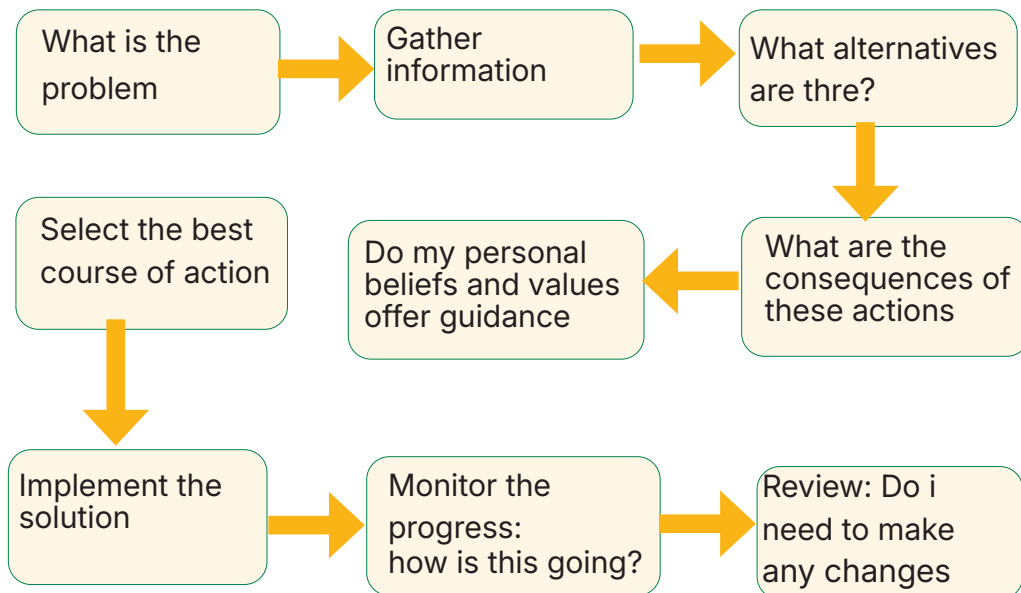
What do you think are the benefits of living in accordance with the purpose of creation?

Living in accordance with the purpose of creation means behaving in a way that follows God's will. According to Christian and Islamic teachings, human beings were created to worship God, live moral lives, care for creation, and live peacefully with others.

When people live according to this purpose, they live meaningful and responsible lives.

Living a responsible life means making sound decisions in line with one's purpose.

The following are the steps of making sound good decisions:



*Steps to pass through while discerning and making good decisions
in line with the purpose of creation.*

I live according to my purpose means to survive and thrive:

Being	• I care for my spiritual, physical and mental wellbeing
Doing	• I live responsibly and morally and I care for the environment
Thinking	• I think about how I feel and what I need to reach my goals and make good life choices
Identity	• I know that I am unique and valuable person
Skills	• I always build my abilities and my strength
Relationship	• I show respect for human dignity and act with kindness

Importance of living according to the purpose of creation

The following are the individual benefits of living according to the purpose of creation

a) It helps to have a meaningful Life

Living according to the purpose of creation helps individuals understand why they exist. It gives direction, hope, and meaning in life.

b) Promotes good moral behavior

When people live according to God's purpose, they avoid bad behaviors such as stealing, violence, and dishonesty and they practice love, respect, obedience, and self-control. This helps individuals become morally upright citizens.

c) Brings Inner Peace and Self-Discipline

Living according to God's will brings peace of mind. It helps individuals control their actions and make good decisions.

d) Strengthens Relationship with God

Worshipping and obeying God strengthen the relationship between human beings and their creator. This brings spiritual growth and faith.

The following are importance of living in accordance with the purpose of creation to the community or society.

e) Promotes Peace and Unity

When people live according to the purpose of creation, they respect one another, forgive, and avoid conflict. This promotes peace and unity in society.

f) Encourages Respect for Human Dignity

Understanding that all humans are created by God helps society respect every person regardless of religion, gender, or background.

g) Reduces Crime and Social Problems

When people follow moral values such as honesty and responsibility, crimes like corruption, violence, and abuse are reduced.

h) Promotes Care for Creation

Living according to the purpose of creation encourages people to protect the environment, forests, water sources, and animals.

i) Supports Sustainable Development

Responsible use of natural resources ensures that future generations will also benefit from the natural world.

An example of how to know if you are living according to the purpose of creation:

Christianity and Islam both teach that human beings are created by God for a purpose. This purpose includes worshiping God, obeying His commands, serving others, caring for creation, and preparing for life after death. Understanding these teachings helps learners live meaningful, responsible, and peaceful lives.



Application activity 4.4

Discuss the importance of living in accordance with the purpose of creation to the individual and society.



4.5 End of unit assessment

I. Knowledge & Understanding

Circle the correct answer

1. The main purpose of human creation in Islam is to:
 - a) Become rich
 - b) Worship Allah
 - c) Rule others
 - d) Enjoy life only
2. In Christianity, humans are created to:
 - a) Ignore others
 - b) Love and serve God and neighbour
 - c) Live without rules
 - d) Focus only on material things

True or False

3. Both Christianity and Islam teach that humans should care for creation. ____

4. Life has no meaning according to religious teachings. ____

Skills

5. Explain how caring for the environment shows obedience to God.

6. Explain the importance of living according to the purpose of creation for an individual.

Attitudes and Values

Answer Yes / No

7. Should learners respect others because they are created by God? ____

8. Can honesty and forgiveness promote peace in society? ____

9. Which value have you learned from this unit, and how will you practice it in your daily life?

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